

## 2.8 www.ning.com

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With a tagline “Create your own Social Network” Ning focuses more on the community part of social networking and less on individual friends. Joining Ning is meaningless if you don’t join a community inside. In fact Ning is what is



referred to as mashups, a vast directory of networks, catering to every possible interest. There are more than 70,000, so you would be spoilt for choice. Some of the communities are open by invitation, while others are open to public. There is a basic template which can be modified by individual community owners to suit their design needs. Running on PHP and Java, the site was started in October 2005 by Marc Andreessen (the cofounder of Netscape and co author of Mosaic, the first graphical browser) and Gina Bianchini.

Ning’s service is free. Anyone can create a custom social network. Owners can get a copy of the source code of the basic template and tweak them using a variety of bells and whistles. The networks within Ning can add their own logos and visual design. Even e-mails and newsletters don’t have to be in the same boring format, they automatically assume the look



A community on Ning